

Introduction

Welcome to one the most exciting Fast Tracks you will ever read. This month we dive deep into the world of the Raspberry Pi microcomputer. The latest model of the device - the Raspberry Pi 2 - was released in February 2015 and we happened to get our hands on a few of these beauties. After weeks of tinkering around and exploring the various unique projects, we are happy to present the Fast Track to Raspberry Pi.

We start off this month's issue by explaining what a Raspberry Pi is exactly and clarifying a few misconceptions regarding its usage. We explain how the Raspberry Pi isn't a conventional computing device and justify how it needs to be critiqued against a unique benchmark. We trace the history of its origins and present a detailed overview of its hardware evolution - demystifying how such a versatile and powerful device can be so cheap.

This edition also delves into the reasons as to why the Raspberry Pi has achieved such unprecedented popularity despite alternatives like the BeagleBone and Intel Galileo being more powerful. This eventually leads us into the innovation philosophy and broader goals of the Raspberry Foundation.

We then take a step-by-step journey to guide the first time Raspberry Pi user from unboxing to complete set-up. The chapters also include the various options that come with the Raspberry Pi with respect to its scalability and range of operating systems. This chapter also wets readers creative appetite by taking a closer look at some really interesting projects that have been implemented using the Raspberry Pi - from a weather camera to a supercomputer.

We hope to aid the reader in starting off with some really simple but useful Do-It-Yourself projects using the Raspberry Pi through a series of chapters. There were a tonne of DIYs to choose from and we've broadly